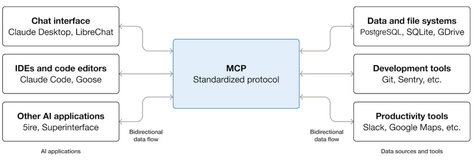
WHAT IS MCP?

Model Context Protocol

Allows AI tools to connect with external
data sources and services



- Local or remote files
- Databases and APIs
- Developer tools like Git and package managers
- Search engines and third-party services

MCP gives access to the real world!

Local & Remote MCP Servers

MCP servers can run locally or remote

Local MCP

- Runs on your local machine via Node.js/Python process
- Communicates with stdio for fast, direct interaction with local files/apps
- Pros: High privacy, works offline, full control OS-level acces
- Cons: Limited to your machine, harder to share with web-based agents
- Best for individual devs needing quick, private access to local resources

Remote MCP

- Runs on cloud servers (SaaS)
- Connects with HTTP/Web Sockets and OAuth
- Pros: Accessible from anywhere, no local setup, easy for sharing
- Cons: Relies on internet, potential privacy concerns
- Best for web apps, enterprise use, collaborative environments

MCP Setup

Setup of MCP servers depends on the tool/client you are using.
Most clients have a specific file to link up the MCP
Cursor has one click installs within IDE for many MCP servers.
Claude Code has commands to install

Claude MCP Scopes:

Local Scope: Remain private, single project /project/.claude.json
Project Scope: Team collab, single project /project/.mcp.json
User Scope: Private to user, multiple projects ~/.claude.json

Example of a command (You can provide the scope as a flag)

```
claude mcp add --transport http stripe https://mcp.stripe.com
claude mcp add --transport http stripe --scope local https://mcp.stripe.com

claude mcp list # This will show all MCP servers
```

Keep in mind, MCP tools use context just to load in